PLAYER HANDBOOK

Core Rules

CREATE · PLAY · IMPROVE / 2.0 BETA

FROM YOUR FIRST IDEA TO YOUR NEXT ADVENTURE

Create a character. Learn the dice and combat. Choose Talents, shape magic and grow through play.

YOUR GUIDE TO PLAYING

Create a character, or begin with a ready-made sheet. Say what you want to do; the GM describes what happens and calls for a roll when the outcome matters.

MAKE YOUR FIRST CHARACTER

1. Write a concept and assign characteristics: page 5.
2. Choose any campaign ancestry and pay its innate package: page 6.
3. Calculate attributes and base skills: page 8-10.
4. If starting as a Shaper, reserve its 20 IP before skill allocation.
5. Allocate skill points, spend starting IP and equip yourself: page 11-12.
6. Check the complete example on page 13.

THE NUMBERS IN PLAY

- **Skill %:** test target; at 60%, roll 60 or less unless it Fumbles.
- **HP:** current / maximum Hit Points; injury lowers current HP.
- **PP:** current / maximum Power Points; fuel magic and some items.
- **MWL:** Major Wound Level; the damage from one hit that wounds you.
- **Movement:** metres per Movement Action.
- **Combat Order:** add to 1D10 when combat starts.
- **DM:** Damage Modifier; add to melee, unarmed and thrown damage, not bows, crossbows or slings.
- **AP:** Armour Points, subtracted after Parry.
- **ENC:** equipment burden. Armour ENC also reduces Combat Order.
- **Hero Points:** spendable chances to change an outcome.

READ IT CORRECTLY

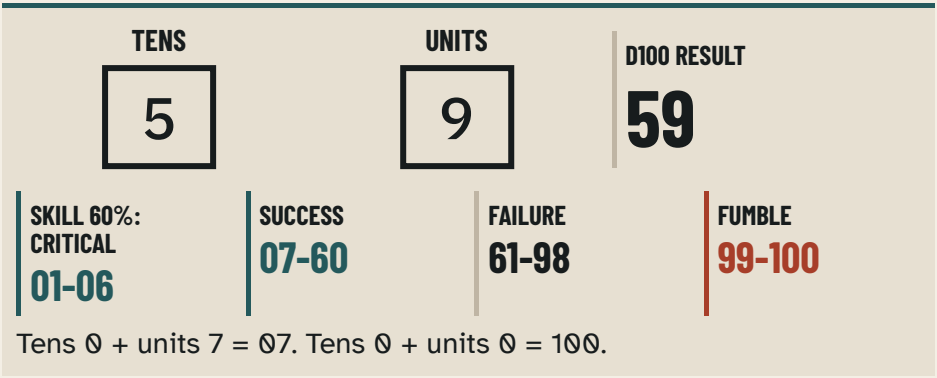
HP 8/12: 8 current, 12 maximum. **MWL 6 stays 6** when you lose HP. Use armour-adjusted Combat Order; do not subtract its ENC twice.

FIND IT FAST

Rolls: page 3-4. **Combat:** page 15. **Wounds / Hero Points:** page 25-26. **Travel / hazards:** page 27-31. **Equipment:** page 32. **Improvement:** page 14. **Talents:** page 37. **Shaping:** page 49.

ROLL & READ THE DICE

Say what you want to achieve and how you try. Roll when uncertainty, pressure or danger makes failure matter. Routine and impossible actions need no roll.



Tens 0 + units 7 = 07. Tens 0 + units 0 = 100.

TWO DICE MAKE D100

Choose **two ten-sided dice: tens and units**. Set Bonus/Penalty dice first (page 4). Read the examples above; **two zeros mean 100**, never zero.

GRADE YOUR RESULT

Check Fumbles first: they override success. Skills cannot exceed 100%.

- **Critical:** 01 through one tenth of your skill, rounded down. Any skill above 0% has at least 01 as a Critical; a 0% skill has none.
- **Success:** at or below your skill, without a Critical or Fumble.
- **Failure:** above your skill, without a Fumble.
- **Fumble:** 99 or 100 below 100% skill; at 100% skill, only 100.

A Critical achieves your intent exceptionally well. A Fumble fails with a serious, risk-related consequence. Combat Criticals: page 17. Lower is not always better: compare **grade first** (page 4).

OTHER DICE AND MEASURES

2D6+2: total two six-sided dice, then add 2. D gives the die's sides. Distances use metres; a grid square may represent 2 m. Round ordinary fractions to the nearest whole number, **halves up**. The Critical threshold specifically rounds **down**.

BETTER ROLLS, SHARED TESTS

Bonus dice keep the better result; Penalty dice keep the worse.
Your skill and Critical range do not change.

ONE UNITS DIE: 5 · TENS: 2 AND 6 · CANDIDATES: 25 / 65

BOTH SUCCEED · HIGHER IS STRONGER
+1B: 65 · -1P: 25

SUCCESS BEATS FAILURE
+1B: 25 · -1P: 65

Choose grade first. Within the same successful grade, the higher result wins an opposed test.

BUILD AND CHOOSE

Cancel +B and -P one for one; keep at most **+3B or -3P**.

Roll one units die, one tens die, and an extra tens die per remaining Bonus or Penalty die. Pair every tens die with the **same units die**; 00 is still 100.

Choose by grade first: **Critical > Success > Failure > Fumble**. Within the same Critical/Success grade, **higher is better**; within Failure/Fumble, **lower is better**. Penalties reverse the choice.

COMPETING: ROLL AGAINST SOMEONE

Both choose their result, then compare **grade**, number and **unmodified skill**. An exact tie goes to the defender.

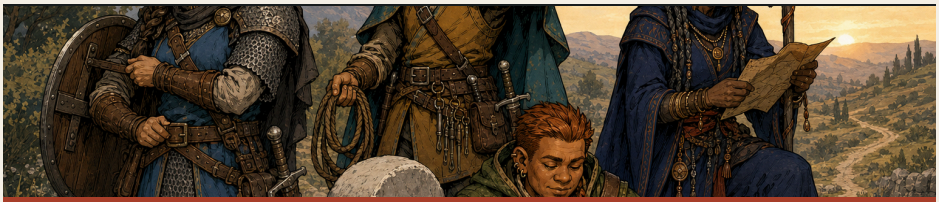
Deception **42 Success** beats Perception **31 Success**: same grade, higher number. Ordinary attacks use attack-then-Reaction (page 16); grappling is opposed.

HELPING: ONE COMBINED BONUS

Useful, timely help gives **+1B total**, not per helper. Assistants normally need **26% or more** in the relevant skill. Exceptional combined help may give **+2B**.

MAKE A CHARACTER

Write one sentence: **who you are, what you do well, and what drives you**. Agree a place in the campaign with the GM and other players. There are no classes.



A PERSON FIRST, THEN THE NUMBERS

CHOOSE CHARACTERISTICS

Score	What it measures
STR / Strength	Power and force.
CON / Constitution	Health and endurance.
DEX / Dexterity	Coordination and reactions.
SIZ / Size	Height, mass and bulk.
INT / Intelligence	Reasoning and memory.
POW / Power	Will and inner reserves.
CHA / Charisma	Presence and leadership.

ALLOCATE 30 POINTS

A human starts at **8 in each score**. Other ancestries start with the spread on page 6. Add **30 points**; lowering scores returns points to spend. Finish with **INT and SIZ at least 7**, all others at least **3**. No score may exceed **18 or its racial maximum, whichever is lower**.

All point-built characters start with **86 characteristic points in total**. Remember weapon STR/DEX requirements when choosing your scores.

HUMAN RANDOM ALTERNATIVE

With the group's agreement, instead roll **4D6, drop the lowest** for STR, CON, DEX, POW and CHA. For INT and SIZ, roll **3D6, drop the lowest, add 6**. After all seven rolls, you may swap one pair. Nonhuman random generation uses the campaign's racial dice, not these human rolls.

CHOOSE YOUR ANCESTRY

These are the six recommended player ancestries. **Ask which fit the campaign.** Your culture, loyalties and personality are your own, not dictated by ancestry.

STARTING SPREAD: ADD 30 POINTS

Ancestry	STR	CON	DEX	SIZ	INT	POW	CHA
Human	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
Elf	6	8	10	6	10	8	8
Dwarf	10	12	6	4	8	8	8
Orc	10	8	8	10	6	6	8
Goblin	6	7	12	4	9	8	10
Lizardfolk	11	8	6	8	9	7	7

These are starting spreads, **not finished scores**. Raise INT and SIZ to at least 7. The usual point-creation maximum is 18, or a lower racial maximum.

RACIAL MAXIMA: FOR LATER IMPROVEMENT

Ancestry	STR	CON	DEX	SIZ	INT	POW	CHA
Human	21	21	21	21	21	21	21
Elf	18	21	27	18	27	21	21
Dwarf	27	27	21	18	21	21	21
Orc	27	21	21	24	18	18	21
Goblin	18	18	27	15	21	18	21
Lizardfolk	27	21	18	21	21	21	21

SIZ normally cannot be improved with IP, even when its maximum is higher.

PAY FOR INNATE ABILITIES

Deduct the mandatory package from your **10 starting IP**: Human **0**, Elf **5**, Dwarf **7**, Orc **4**, Goblin **5**, Lizardfolk **6**. The next page explains them. They are not free extras. Other profiles and racial dice need GM agreement.

INNATE ABILITIES

Buy your ancestry's whole package from starting IP. **Humans buy none and keep all 10 IP.** Other Talents remain normal purchases if you meet their requirements.

ELF: 5 IP

Low-Light Sight (3): Partial darkness counts as Illuminated; Darkness counts as Partial darkness. Pitch black and obscurity do not change.

Terrain Expertise: Forest (2): remove one remaining Penalty die from Natural Lore in or about forests, after cancellation and before the cap. This racial purchase waives the usual Natural Lore prerequisite. It never creates a Bonus.

DWARF: 7 IP

Blind Sight: heat (5): perceive heat-contrasting targets regardless of light. Solid barriers, heavy insulation and ambient-temperature targets defeat it. No colour, writing, fine visual detail or eye contact.

Earth Sense (2): touching connected earth or stone reveals approximate depth and whether the surrounding chamber is structurally unstable.

ORC: 4 IP

Adrenaline Surge: once per combat, immediately after becoming Wounded or Fatigued, ignore both conditions' test, Movement and Combat Order penalties through the end of your next turn. Ignore the first **1 HP of Bleeding** in that time. Bleeding remains; Exhausted, unconsciousness and Dying are unaffected.

GOBLIN: 5 IP

Blind Sight: heat: as for Dwarves. Close-Quarters Knack is optional, not free.

LIZARDFOLK: 6 IP

Scaled Hide (4): 1 natural AP, no ENC, added to worn armour. Use that combined physical AP or Ward AP, whichever is higher, never both.

Counterbalancing Tail (2): tests primarily intended to knock you prone, throw you or force you to move suffer **-1P**.

CALCULATE YOUR ATTRIBUTES

Use your final characteristics. Round to the nearest whole number, **halves up**. Calculate maximum HP first, then use that rounded maximum to calculate MWL.

NUMBERS TO PUT ON YOUR SHEET

Attribute	Calculation
Maximum Hit Points / HP	(SIZ + CON) / 2
Major Wound Level / MWL	Maximum HP / 2
Maximum Power Points / PP	POW
Human Movement	15 metres
Combat Order	(DEX + INT) / 2, then subtract worn armour ENC
Carrying capacity	STR + SIZ ENC

Record **current and maximum** HP/PP separately. Injury never lowers MWL. Add any Talent adjustment to Combat Order; do not subtract armour twice. For an unusual ancestry, confirm any different Movement with the GM.

DAMAGE MODIFIER: STR + SIZ

Total	DM	Total	DM
1-10	-1D6	31-45	+1D6
11-15	-1D4	46-60	+2D6
16-25	+0	61-75	+3D6
26-30	+1D4	Each further 15	Another +1D6

Add DM to **melee, unarmed and thrown** damage, including a negative DM. Bows, crossbows, slings and Shaping do not normally add it.

POWER IS A RESOURCE

At **0 PP**, a living character falls unconscious until PP returns. Rest restores one quarter of maximum PP per complete **2 hours**, rounded normally; **8 hours restores all**. PP matters even if you use a magical item rather than cast.

SKILLS / FIGHT & KNOW

Start with the base, then add allocated points. General skills are available even if you spend no points on them.

RESISTANCES AND COMBAT

Skill	Base	Use it to...
Dodge	DEX + 10	Evade a perceived attack or physical hazard.
Persistence	POW + 10	Resist fear, coercion and mental magic.
Resilience	CON + POW	Endure bodily harm, fatigue and afflictions.
Close Combat	DEX + STR	Attack and Parry with melee weapons/shields.
Ranged Combat	DEX + INT	Shoot or throw at a distance.
Unarmed Combat	DEX + STR	Punch, kick, grapple; Parry unarmed blows.

KNOWLEDGE

Skill	Base	Use it to...
Culture (own)	INT + 10	Recall your society's history and customs.
Culture (other)	INT	Understand another named society.
Language (own)	INT + 50	Speak your native language.
Language (other)	INT	Communicate in another named language.
Lore (own field)	INT + 10	Know your chosen field of study.
Lore (other)	INT	Know another named field.
Natural Lore	INT + 10	Track, navigate, find food and understand nature.
Shaping	INT + POW	Cast magic; **requires the 20 IP Talent**.

Choose **one own Lore field**, such as Alchemy or Military Tactics. Each Culture, Language and Lore subject is separate. **Language 50%** gives fluent everyday speech.

SKILLS / GET THINGS DONE

Add points from the **Practical** pool. Every chosen Craft trade is a separate skill.

PRACTICAL SKILLS

Skill	Base	Use it to...
Athletics	DEX + STR	Balance, climb, jump, swim and exert force.
Craft (type)	INT + 10	Make and repair goods in your trade.
Deception	DEX + INT	Sneak, disguise, misdirect or pick pockets.
Driving	DEX + INT	Handle carts, wagons and similar vehicles.
Engineering	INT + 10	Build, operate or sabotage large works.
Healing	INT + 10	Treat injuries, stabilise and perform Surgery.
Influence	CHA + 10	Persuade, bargain, command or intimidate.
Mechanisms	DEX + INT	Open locks; disable, make or repair devices.
Perception	INT + POW	Notice details, hidden things and danger.
Performance	CHA + 10	Act, speak, sing, dance or play music.
Riding	DEX + POW	Control a mount in difficult conditions.
Sailing	DEX + INT	Operate a boat or ship under oar or sail.
Streetwise	CHA + POW	Find rumours, contacts, illicit goods and routes.
Trade	INT + 10	Appraise value and negotiate a sale.

USE THE RIGHT SKILL, NOT EVERY SKILL

Describe what you try; the GM chooses the relevant test. Routine work with time and tools often needs no roll. Helping and opposed tests: page 4.

ALLOCATE YOUR SKILL POINTS

Each category has its own pool. Add points to bases from the preceding pages: **one point raises one skill by 1 percentage point**.

RESISTANCES	COMBAT	KNOWLEDGE	PRACTICAL
50	50	50	75

STAY INSIDE THE LIMITS

Add **no more than 30 points to any one skill** from these pools. No score may exceed **100%**. You cannot move points from one category's pool into another. Different Craft, Culture, Language and Lore subjects are separate skills.

Example: DEX 14 + STR 14 gives Close Combat 28%. Adding 30 Combat points makes it **58%**, leaving 20 Combat points for Ranged and/or Unarmed Combat.

TRADE SKILL POINTS FOR STARTING IP

You may remove up to **20 points each** from Resistances, Combat and Practical. Each **5 removed gives 1 IP**: at most 4 IP per category, **12 bonus IP total**. Knowledge cannot be traded.

These bonus IP may buy Talents or raise characteristics, **not raise skills**. Keep them separate from your normal 10 starting IP, and record each expenditure.

WANT TO BEGIN AS A SHAPER?

Declare Shaping and **reserve its full 20 IP before allocating skills**. Only then may you put up to 30 Knowledge points into Shaping (base INT + POW).

Human example: trade 20 Resistance, 20 Combat and 10 Practical points. That yields **10 bonus IP + 10 normal IP = 20 IP** for Shaping. Your remaining pools are **30 / 30 / 50 / 65**. No IP remain for other purchases.

Nonhuman innate packages also cost IP; do not count the same points twice. If the available budget cannot pay both, start without Shaping and learn it later.

FINISH & EQUIP YOURSELF

You start with **10 IP**, minus any innate package, plus IP gained by trading skill points. Spend or save them. **Every PC begins with 2 Hero Points.**

SPEND STARTING IP

1 IP: improve a skill, using page 14. Only normal starting IP can do this; do not repeatedly buy the same skill's starting improvement. **5 IP:** raise a characteristic by 1, not SIZ; creation caps still apply. **Listed cost:** buy a Talent whose prerequisites you meet.

When you buy a characteristic improvement, update derived attributes; existing skill scores do not change. Track each expenditure.

CHOOSE ONE FREE EQUIPMENT PACKAGE

Both give **leather armour, one ranged weapon and a dagger**. Add either:

- **One two-handed close-combat weapon**, or
- **One shield and one one-handed close-combat weapon**.

Check STR/DEX requirements. A Flex weapon may be used with one or two hands; ask the GM which starting package it fills. Weapons and armour: page 32-36.

PACK AND PURSE

Also take a **backpack, 10 m rope, two weeks of travelling provisions, flint and tinder, and a waterskin**. Roll **4D6 × 10 SP** for starting money; the GM may allow purchases before play. Confirm ammunition and any specialist kit.

100 CP = 10 SP = 1 GP. Check the website equipment list for additional goods and local availability; free starting equipment does not spend your silver.

FINAL CHECK

Name, appearance, background, personality, loyalties and an immediate goal. Humans normally start aged **18-28**, or roll **2D6 + 16**. Note weapons, AP, carried ENC, armour-adjusted Combat Order, full HP/PP and **2 Hero Points**.

A CHARACTER FROM SCRATCH

Ilan, human caravan guard: protects travelling companions while searching for his missing brother. This example spends every creation pool exactly.

1. CHARACTERISTICS: 56 + 30 = 86

STR 14 · CON 13 · DEX 14 · SIZ 12 · INT 13 · POW 10 · CHA 10. All scores meet the creation limits. No points are traded for extra IP.

2. ALLOCATE THE FOUR SKILL POOLS

Pool	Added points -> final scores
Resistances / 50	Dodge +30 -> **54%**; Persistence +10 -> **30%**; Resilience +10 -> **33%**.
Combat / 50	Close +30 -> **58%**; Ranged +10 -> **37%**; Unarmed +10 -> **38%**.
Knowledge / 50	Culture (own) +10 -> **33%**; Natural Lore +20 -> **43%**; Lore (Military Tactics, own) +20 -> **43%**.
Practical / 75	Athletics +20 -> **48%**; Deception +15 -> **42%**; Perception +20 -> **43%**; Healing +10 -> **33%**; Mechanisms +10 -> **37%**.

Every unlisted general skill stays at its base, including Language (own) **63%**. No pool gives more than 30 points to any skill.

3. SPEND 10 IP; CHOOSE EQUIPMENT

Quick Reflexes 3 + Shield Cover 3 + Missile Guard 2 + Disarm 2 = 10 IP. DEX 14, Dodge 54% and Close Combat 58% meet all requirements.

Take leather, medium shield, arming sword, shortbow, dagger and the standard pack. All weapon requirements are met. A starting-money total of 14 on 4D6 gives **140 SP**.

4. RECORD THE FINAL ATTRIBUTES

HP 13/13 · MWL 7 · PP 10/10 · DM +1D4 · AP 2 · Movement 15 m. Combat Order: round (14 + 13) / 2 to 14, subtract leather ENC 3, add Quick Reflexes 2 = **13**. Carrying capacity **26 ENC**. Begin with **2 Hero Points**.

IMPROVE & BUY TALENTS

Spend earned **Improvement Points between adventures**. Unspent IP carry forward. The GM awards them for progress and achievements; three months of suitable practice/research may earn 1 IP with approval.

BUY AN IMPROVEMENT

Spend	Gain
1 IP, skill currently 0-50%	+5 percentage points.
1 IP, skill currently 51-99%	+3 percentage points.
5 IP	+1 characteristic, not SIZ; respect racial maximum.
Talent's listed IP	Buy it if you meet its prerequisites.

Improve each skill **at most once between adventures**. Use its score before the gain; cap at 100%. **50 -> 55; 51 -> 54; 98 -> 100.**

After a characteristic increase, recalculate attributes, including a Shaper's active limit. **Skills keep their scores**; their bases only seed creation. New Shaping cells have separate costs on page 49.

HOW TO READ A TALENT

Pay once and record it. Meet skill/characteristic prerequisites when buying; listed equipment is a requirement when using it. The catalogue starts on page 37; magical Talents appear beside the Shaping rules.

Passive: applies when its conditions hold. **Action:** spends your Combat Action. **Reaction:** spends the Reaction its text names.

Only **one action Talent** may modify an attack. That attack is not a standard attack for an extra off-hand attack. Passive Talents still apply when eligible. Forfeiting **all Reactions** includes both base and extra Reactions.

WHEN A TALENT SAYS "NOT STOPPED"

An ordinary hit is stopped by a successful Dodge or full-block Parry; partial Parry does not stop it. A **Critical hit needs a Critical Reaction** to stop it. Apply partial Parry before armour if the Talent deals damage. Replacement damage/effects follow the Talent, not the normal Critical benefits.

YOUR COMBAT ROUND

One round is five seconds. Close is within 2 m; farther away is Ranged.

EACH ROUND	EACH ROUND	WHEN TRIGGERED
1 ACTION	1 MOVE	1 REACTION

ESTABLISH THE ORDER

At combat start, roll **1D10 + Combat Order**; highest acts first. Ties go to higher DEX; if DEX also ties, those characters reroll 1D10 between them. Example: die **7** + Combat Order **12** = **19**.

SPEND DURING THE ROUND

Combat Action: attack, start/escape a grapple, Aim, Set Weapon, Intimidate, cast a Shaping, activate an item, or use a skill/object that takes about five seconds.

Movement Action: move up to Movement in metres, stand, drop prone or disengage. Leaving an enemy can trigger an Opportunity Attack (page 19).

Base Reaction: when eligible, Dodge, Parry or make an Opportunity Attack, even outside your turn. It interrupts only to resolve its trigger.

Combat and Movement Actions happen in Combat Order. Unspent actions never carry into the next round. You must still have every Action or Reaction an option spends or gives up before you choose it.

READY EQUIPMENT

Use Movement Action to ready **one item or nock an arrow** while moving no more than **half Movement**. Stow one and draw another, or ready two items: use the whole Movement Action. Crossbow reload costs are separate (page 34).

DELAY

Delay your Combat Action until after a chosen participant later this round. To interrupt an action already beginning, oppose the relevant skills; winner acts first. Delaying never creates an extra action.

ATTACK, DODGE & PARRY

Attack first; an aware defender may React after a hit. Not an opposed test.

ORDINARY PARRY AGAINST A HEAVY ATTACK

MEDIUM SHIELD · HEAVY	ARMING SWORD · MEDIUM	DAGGER · LIGHT
BLOCK ALL	BLOCK HALF	BLOCK NONE

1. MAKE THE ATTACK

Roll **Close Combat**, **Unarmed Combat** or **Ranged Combat**. Success hits; failure misses. Check Criticals and Fumbles normally (page 3).

2. CHOOSE A DEFENCE

Melee or unarmed: Dodge normally, or Parry with a ready weapon or shield.

Ranged: Dodge at **-1P**. A ranged Parry uses Active Guard (page 22), with different choices for thrown weapons and projectiles.

An ordinary successful Dodge avoids the hit. You must perceive it and be able to move. Dodge only **once per round, using your base Reaction**. Parry uses Close Combat, or Unarmed Combat against an unarmed attack.

A failed Reaction changes nothing. **One Reaction per attack or trigger.** An unaware defender cannot React. Critical attacks use page 17.

3. COMPARE PARRY SIZE

Sizes ascend: **Light, Medium, Heavy, Huge**. Against an ordinary hit, a Parry of the same/larger Size blocks **all**; one smaller blocks **half**; two or more smaller blocks **none**. Then apply armour. Unarmed attacks are Light.

A **Critical Parry blocks all damage regardless of Size**.

OPPORTUNITY ATTACK

When an adjacent enemy disengages or creates a clear opening, spend an eligible Reaction on one Close Combat attack. It grants no extra off-hand attack.

DAMAGE & CRITICAL HITS

Resolve the Reaction before reducing HP. Critical attacks change damage and defence, not the number of attacks you make.

ORDINARY HEAVY HIT · MEDIUM PARRY · LEATHER ARMOUR

ROLLED DAMAGE	PARRY BLOCKS	ARMOUR REMOVES	HP LOST
12	-6	-2	4

Parry first, armour second. Only the remaining damage reaches HP.

ORDINARY DAMAGE

Roll weapon damage; add applicable **DM** and declared action damage; apply **Parry**, subtract **AP**, then lose the remaining **HP**. Damage and current HP cannot fall below 0. Round halves up.

DM applies to melee, unarmed and thrown damage, including negative DM. Bows, crossbows and slings use their listed damage.

AN ORDINARY ATTACK HITS

None, failed or fumbled Reaction: roll damage, then armour. **Successful Dodge:** no damage. **Ordinary Parry:** reduce by Size, then armour (page 16). **Critical Dodge or Parry:** no damage.

A CRITICAL ATTACK HITS

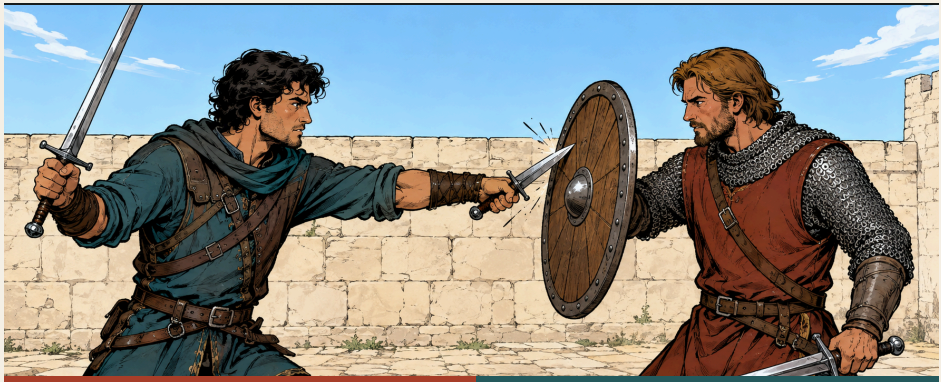
- **No Reaction, failed or fumbled Reaction:** maximum weapon damage plus maximum positive DM when normally added; **ignore armour**. Ignore negative DM and all other bonus damage, including the extra Charge die.
- **Ordinary successful Dodge or Parry:** roll normal damage and apply armour. The Reaction **neither stops nor reduces** the hit.
- **Critical Dodge or Parry:** no damage; Critical Parry ignores Size.

CHECK THE CONSEQUENCES

A Critical gives no free attack or manoeuvre. A Fumble brings a consequence suited to the risk, such as dropping a weapon or losing your footing. After HP loss, check **Major Wound and 0 HP** (page 25).

YOUR OTHER HAND

Two ready one-handed items give one extra option per round. Attack OR defend.



EXTRA DAGGER ATTACK -1P | BASE SHIELD PARRY: NO OFF-HAND PENALTY

WHAT QUALIFIES?

Weapon + weapon; weapon + shield; weapon + free hand; two bare hands. An empty hand counts as ready; a punch or kick can attack. A **two-handed item does not qualify**: it leaves no free hand.

EXTRA ATTACK: FOLLOW IMMEDIATELY

After a **standard Close Combat or Unarmed Combat attack**, immediately make one free attack with the other item, or unarmed with a free hand, at **-1P**. Spend no Action or Reaction; add DM to both attacks normally. The first attack does **not** need to hit.

EXTRA DEFENCE: RESERVE THE ITEM

Keep the other item for one additional **Parry or Opportunity Attack at -1P**. This extra Reaction **cannot Dodge**. Your base Reaction remains available with either choice; a base shield Parry has **no inherent off-hand penalty**. Other situational penalties still apply.

ONE CHOICE, NOT BOTH

Using either extra option locks out the other until next round. An Opportunity Attack, Charge or Set Weapon attack never produces an extra off-hand attack. Forfeiting all Reactions also removes the extra Reaction. Only one Reaction answers any one attack.

MOVE, CHARGE & SET

You must still have every listed Action and Reaction available.

SET WEAPON: ATTACK FIRST +1B | CHARGE HIT: +1D6 DAMAGE

DISENGAGE OR WITHDRAW

Disengage: Movement Action to leave; an enemy in reach may make an Opportunity Attack.

Withdraw: Combat + Movement Actions; move normally without those Opportunity Attacks. Keep your base Reaction.

SPRINT

Combat + Movement Actions: move up to **twice Movement**. Keep only your base Reaction, and use it only to Dodge.

CHARGE

Combat + Movement Actions; forfeit all Reactions. Move **5 m to twice Movement** in a straight, clear route, end adjacent, then attack. A hit adds **+1D6 damage**. No other movement or off-hand attack.

SET WEAPON AGAINST A CHARGE

Combat Action to set a ready **Set-tagged weapon**. A Charge into reach before your next turn triggers one Close Combat attack at **+1B before the Charge**.

It works once. Any Action, Movement Action or Reaction before the trigger unsets it.

SEIZE & ESCAPE

Use this when you want to grab and hold someone, not injure them.

HELD: BOTH -1P · NO MOVEMENT ACTIONS

SEIZE: COMBAT ACTION

Choose an adjacent target and commit one free hand. An aware target may spend **one eligible Reaction** before opposing your **Unarmed Combat** with **Dodge or Parry**. Dodge uses the base Reaction, once per round. Parry uses Close Combat with a ready weapon/shield, or Unarmed Combat empty-handed.

Win to hold them. Without a defence Reaction, succeed at an unopposed Unarmed Combat test instead. A failed attempt leaves your hand free.

WHILE HELD TOGETHER

Neither participant can take a Movement Action, and **both suffer -1P on every test**. They may attack or Parry only with Unarmed Combat or a ready **Light one-handed weapon**. A hand used to hold cannot attack, Parry or count as an off-hand.

ESCAPE: COMBAT ACTION

The held participant spends a Combat Action and wins **Unarmed Combat versus Unarmed Combat**; the controller's opposing roll costs no Reaction. The controller may release freely on their turn. Escape or release leaves both adjacent and frees the committed hand.

Only one controller can hold a target. The GM handles unusual Size, anatomy, footing and help.

TAKE THE SHOT

Spend a **Combat Action** and test **Ranged Combat**. Cover modifies this roll; the defender reacts only after a hit.

RANGE

Up to listed Range (**R**): normal. Beyond R through **2R: -2P**. Beyond 2R: no shot. **Shortbow:** R = 75 m; 2R = 150 m.

AIM

Spend a **Combat Action** aiming at one visible target: **+1B** to your next ranged attack against it. Lose Aim on **any Reaction**, loss of sight, or failure to shoot with your **next Combat Action**.

DAMAGE AND CLOSE USE

Thrown weapons add **DM** and keep their listed **Size**. Bows, crossbows, and slings add no DM; their projectiles are **Light**.

Within **2 m**, a **Close**-tagged ranged weapon can use Close Combat and its listed damage. Without that tag, it is an improvised **Light club: 1D6 + DM**, attacking at **-1P**.

SHOOTING INTO A CROWD

Apply cover normally. An ordinary failure misses. Only a **Fumble** may hit a fairly or randomly selected nearby target: normal rolled damage, then armour.

WORKED SHOT

Aim **+1B** and a low wall **-1P** cancel. Roll normally. If the attack hits, resolve the defender's Reaction separately.

COVER & DEFENCE

Cover changes the attack. An aware defender may React only after a hit.

AFTER A HIT: SHIELD PARRY -1P

TERRAIN COVER

Partial (low wall): attack -1P. Substantial (battlements): attack -2P. Complete: blocked attack line, no attack. Cover absorbs no damage.

DODGE. Dodge -1P: once per round, base Reaction only. Perceive the danger and be able to move away.

ACTIVE GUARD

Test **Close Combat** with an eligible ready item:

- **Thrown weapon:** ready weapon **-1P**; ready shield **no guard penalty**.
- **Arrow, bolt, or sling projectile:** shield only, **-1P**.

Carrying a shield adds **no attack penalty**. A strapped shield cannot guard while you wield a weapon with both hands.

RESOLVE THE DEFENCE

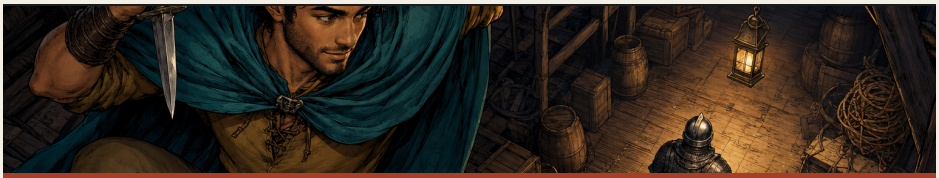
Ordinary hit: successful Dodge avoids it; successful Parry blocks by Size. Any ready shield fully blocks a **Light** projectile on success.

Critical hit: ordinary defence success means normal rolled damage after armour, with no avoidance or Parry reduction. **Critical defence** stops it, regardless of Size.

EXTRA GUARD. Extra off-hand Reaction: **add -1P** (shield vs arrow: **-2P before other modifiers**); cannot Dodge. **One Reaction per attack.**

POSITION & DIFFICULT SHOTS

Use these common modifiers. The GM handles unusual circumstances.



MELEE FROM ABOVE OR BEHIND: ATTACK +1B

RANGED: ON THE ATTACKER'S TEST

- Target moved since your last turn: **10 m or more -1P; 30 m or more -2P instead**.
- Target partly obscured by mist, smoke, fog or foliage: **-1P**; heavily **-2P**.
- Target prone: **-1P**. Target helpless: **+2B**.
- You are on unstable ground: **-1P**. Prone firing depends on the weapon; check with the GM.
- You are engaged at Close range: **-2P per enemy**.

Range/Aim: page 21. Terrain cover: page 22. Obscurity is not cover. The GM handles wind and other difficult conditions.

MELEE: ATTACK THE OPENING

- Target prone, flanked or attacked from behind: **attack +1B**.
- Target helpless: **automatic Critical attack**.
- Higher ground: the advantaged **attacker or defender +1B**.
- You are prone: **melee attack or defence -1P**.
- You are on unstable ground: **-1P to the affected test**.

BEHIND DOES NOT MEAN UNNOTICED

An **unaware defender cannot React**. Behind/beside does not automatically mean unnoticed. An alert defender can React to a rear attack; that attack gains +1B.

COMBINE MODIFIERS

Use the strongest version of the same condition; combine different causes. Cancel +B/-P, then cap at **+3B / -3P**.

TALK, TRADE & GO UNNOTICED

Describe what you want and what leverage or concealment makes it possible. Success changes the situation; it does not give control of another person's mind.

MAKE THE DEMAND CLEAR

INTIMIDATE: COMBAT ACTION

State your demand to one enemy or a group. Oppose **Influence against Persistence**. The GM applies modifiers and describes whether an enemy yields or flees. Intimidation is pressure, not mind control.

PERSUADE OR BARGAIN

Use Influence; resistance usually opposes Persistence or Influence. It cannot force a choice against basic self-preservation.

A sale: oppose Trade. Winning buyer reduces price **10%**; winning seller raises it **10%**. A Critical changes it **20%**; double the change if the opponent Fumbles. Appraisal success estimates normal local value within 10%.

AVOID NOTICE OR GAIN ACCESS

Deception opposes Perception for sneaking, disguise or sleight of hand. Picking a pocket or planting a small item normally needs **one minute of access**.

Locks and traps: Mechanisms, normally at least one minute; an interference- resistant device opposes with its maker's Mechanisms. **Streetwise:** rumours or a contact normally take **1D4 hours**.

WOUNDS & SAVING A LIFE

One big hit can wound you. At 0 HP, help is urgent.

HELPER: WHOLE ROUND + HEALING TEST

AFTER REACHING 0 HP: STABILISE BEFORE THE DEADLINE

UNCONSCIOUS + DYING	NEXT ROUND	NEXT ROUND	DIE IF STILL DYING
0 HP	1	2	END OF 3

ONE HIT AT LEAST EQUAL TO MWL

After Parry/armour, **one hit's damage at least equal to MWL** causes a Major Wound. Apply HP loss and both conditions:

Wounded: -1P on every test. Bleeding: lose 1 HP at each round's end.

Conditions do not stack. Later Major Wounds deal damage and can restart Bleeding. No Resilience test or injury table. MWL 6: one **6 HP hit** wounds; two **3 HP hits** do not wound merely by totalling 6.

AT 0 HP: UNCONSCIOUS AND DYING

HP stops at 0. Die if still Dying at the end of the **third Combat Round after reaching 0 HP**. Stabilise before that deadline.

STABILISE: WHOLE ROUND

An adjacent helper spends **Combat Action, Movement Action and all Reactions**. Both remain stationary. Test **Healing** with a Healing Kit or suitable improvised supplies; **-2P without them**.

Success removes **Bleeding and Dying**, restores **0 HP**, and leaves Wounded. Stable at 0 HP means **unconscious**. Stopping Bleeding does not unlock natural recovery from a Major Wound. Treatment and separate Hero Point protections: page 26.

RECOVER & CHANGE YOUR FATE

Stabilise first (page 25). Treat the injury next. Hero Points are a separate choice.

TREAT AND RECOVER

Ordinary damage: after an encounter, a patient who is **not Wounded** may receive **one Healing attempt before their next full rest**. Success restores **1D4 HP**, up to maximum. One attempt per patient, even if it fails.

Major Wound: once stabilised, successful **Surgery** (Healing, outside combat, safe conditions) restores **1 HP** and unlocks natural recovery. A Wounded patient cannot heal naturally before Surgery or equivalent treatment. Ordinary treatment and Surgery suffer **-2P without a Healing Kit**.

Rest: no more than light activity restores **CON / 4 HP per 24 hours**, rounded nearest with halves up, never above maximum. After treatment, Wounded ends only when **current HP > MWL**. CON 14 restores 4/day; MWL 6 ends at 7+ HP.

SPEND 1 HERO POINT WHEN DECLARING AN EFFECT

Try again: reroll a failed test, including a Fumble, after seeing it but before consequences or costs. The new result stands, even if worse. **At most one reroll per test**, regardless of source.

Downgrade a Major Wound: keep the full HP loss but prevent Wounded/Bleeding from that hit. It creates no Major Wound needing Surgery. Existing conditions remain.

Avoid Death: at 0 HP, become stable and unconscious, not Bleeding or Dying. Awaken after the scene at **1 HP**; existing Wounded remains.

Story benefit: with GM approval, add a plausible favourable detail or coincidence. Larger benefits may cost several points; companions may contribute.

Separate effects: with 5 HP and MWL 6, taking 7 damage needs **two points** to both downgrade the Major Wound and Avoid Death. Mark spent points off your sheet.

MOVE & WORK IN THE FIELD

Use **Athletics** for movement and exertion. These are ordinary capabilities, not automatic success when danger, load or poor conditions matter.

ATHLETICS AT A GLANCE

Activity	Usual procedure
Balance / acrobatics	Half Movement without a test; test for full speed.
Climb with holds	Quarter Movement; success doubles that rate when speed or difficulty matters.
Swim	Half Movement in calm water; test in dangerous conditions.
Jump	With a 5 m run, success clears twice your height horizontally or half your height vertically. Standing distances halve. Each extra horizontal metre: -1P, capped normally.
Brute force	Athletics to lift, drag, bend, break or push.

MAKE, PREPARE OR BREAK

Craft: roughly one day per **50 SP of finished value**, materials costing half that value. **Lore:** successful useful preparation gives +1B to one directly related test soon afterwards.

Objects: stationary targets usually need no attack roll. Subtract object AP from damage, then HP; at 0 HP they break. The GM warns before hard materials put your weapon at risk. This is not an automatic Critical.

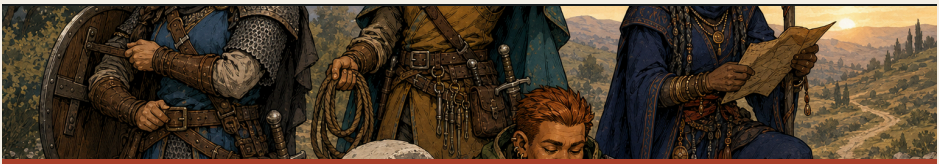
TOOLS WORTH PACKING

Climbing kit: +1B to climbing. **Crowbar:** +1B to brute force. **Lock picks:** +1B to opening locks. **Fishing kit:** +1B to catching fish. **Healing kit:** five Healing/Surgery attempts; each attempt uses one charge, success or failure. Normal kit-less Healing takes -2P.

Walking trained mounts with tack, driving on flat ground and sailing calm water usually need no roll. Test Riding, Driving or Sailing when conditions become dangerous.

TRAVEL & FIND YOUR WAY

Daily rates assume **ten hours of travel in fair conditions**. Agree the route and pace with the group; the GM accounts for difficult conditions and interruptions.



PICK A PACE; MAKE ROOM FOR REST AND SUPPLIES

CHOOSE A PACE

Pace	Per day	Cost or limit
March	30 km	Remain ready to fight; no end-of-day Fatigue test.
Hike	50 km	On foot, no wagons/animals; Fatigue test at day's end.
Ride slowly	30 km	Walking mounts, pack animals or wagons.
Ride	50 km	Casual riding.
Ride fast	90 km	No wagons; rider and mount test Fatigue at day's end.

Multiply by the worst substantial terrain: **road/path 100%; light brush 80%; medium brush, light woods or rolling hills 70%; heavy woodland 50%**. If arrival order matters, oppose Athletics on foot or Riding when mounted.

NAVIGATE, TRACK AND FORAGE

Navigation: Natural Lore once per uncertain travel day, and again after a material route change. Success: full progress. Failure: lose a quarter of that day's progress. Fumble: no progress, and become lost.

Tracking: find the trail, then test every **10 minutes** of uncertain following. **Food, water or shelter:** when a necessity is unavailable, make one Natural Lore test per day to find it before deprivation takes effect.

LOAD, FATIGUE & NECESSITIES

You cannot solve every problem by carrying more or pushing on without rest.

COUNT WHAT YOU CARRY

Add weapons, armour, containers and contents. Capacity is **STR + SIZ ENC**. Over capacity: **-1P to physical tests and Fatigue tests; half Movement**. You cannot carry more than **twice capacity**. Every 20 negligible items in a suitable container count as 1 ENC; containers do not erase their contents' load.

FATIGUE: TEST RESILIENCE

The GM calls for a Fatigue test after strenuous activity, or during it if exhaustion could prevent completion. Failure while fresh makes you Fatigued; failure on another strenuous Fatigue test at -1P makes you Exhausted.

State	All tests	Movement	Combat Order
Fatigued	-1P	Three-quarters	-3
Exhausted	-2P	Half	-6

Use the current state, not both rows. A Fatigue Fumble means unconsciousness for **3D6 minutes**, then wake Fatigued. **20 - CON hours** of complete rest, minimum 1, removes either state. Reduced Movement is at least 1 metre.

FOOD, WATER AND SHELTER

Grace periods: **shelter CON hours; food CON days; water CON × 2 hours**. Water grace becomes CON hours in arid conditions, **CON / 2** in extreme heat. After three days without food, Fatigue tests take -1P even within the grace period.

After a grace period: **one Fatigue test at -1P and 1D6 damage per day for each active deprivation**. That damage cannot heal naturally until you remedy its cause. Magical removal of Fatigue does not supply food, water or shelter.

LIGHT & OTHER SENSES

For vision and attacks, check light **at the target**. For Movement, check light at the mover. Smoke, mist and foliage are separate obscurity, not illumination.

SENSES REVEAL ONLY WHAT THEIR METHOD CAN DETECT

FROM THE LIGHT SOURCE OUTWARD

Band	Effects
Bright / Illuminated	No penalty.
Partial darkness	Vision-based Perception and attacks -1P.
Darkness	Those tests -2P; half Movement.
Pitch black	Sight-based Perception and ranged attacks cannot succeed without another applicable sense; Close attacks -3P; quarter Movement.

Source radii: **candle 1 m; torch/lantern 3 m; campfire 5 m; bonfire 10 m**. Inside radius: Illuminated. Outside through **×3**: Partial darkness; through **×5**: Darkness; farther with no other light: Pitch black.

USE THE BEST APPLICABLE SENSE

Low-Light Sight: improves Partial darkness to Illuminated and Darkness to Partial darkness, not Pitch black. **Night Vision:** natural surface night is Illuminated; no help underground, in sealed/supernatural darkness or obscurity.

Blind Sight: ignores light only where its named sense accurately perceives the target. No colour, writing, fine visual detail or eye contact. Its blockers still apply. Senses never stack.

SURVIVE COMMON HAZARDS

Know the danger before committing.

FALLING

1D6 per full 3 metres, ignoring armour; damage leaves you prone. If conscious, unsurprised and able to control the landing, test Athletics (Acrobatics): success removes **1D6**, Critical **2D6**, and either avoids prone. Failure: normal fall; Fumble: maximise remaining dice. Dice never go below zero.

AIR AND FIRE

Hold breath for **CON rounds**. Then test Resilience each round at cumulative **-1P**, capped at -3P. First failure deals the effect immediately; repeat at each later round's end until breathable air, with **no more breath tests**.

Exposure	Damage / effect each round
Water / vacuum inhaled	2D6; armour does not help.
Thick smoke inhaled	1D6; armour does not help.
Poison gas	Poison exposure; +1D6 if also thick smoke.
Candle / torch / campfire	1 / 1D4 / 1D6 in direct exposure.
Bonfire, steam, burning room / inferno	2D6 / 3D6 in direct exposure.

Metal armour does not reduce fire/heat; other protection must plausibly insulate. Back in breathable air, test Resilience; failure means retching/gasping for **1D4 rounds**.

POISON AND DISEASE

After the listed **Delay**, oppose **Resilience versus Potency**. Win to avoid poison; lose to suffer its full Effect/Duration. **Poison gives one test**. Disease instead repeats after each Delay until you win; its damage cannot heal while it remains active. Successful Healing gives **+1B to the next resistance**. Magical cures: page 53.

CLOSE WEAPONS / A-L

Use **Close Combat** with held weapons; **Unarmed Combat** for punches/kicks. Add **DM** to damage. Below either STR or DEX minimum: **attacks and Parries -1P**, not -2P for both.

Weapon	Type	Damage	STR/DEX	ENC	Size	Cost
Arming Sword	1H	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	150 SP
Ball and Chain	1H	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	120 SP
Battleaxe	1H	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	120 SP
Club	Flex	1D6	5/9	1	Light	20 SP
Dagger	1H/Thrown	1D4+1	-	-	Light	20 SP
Great Axe	2H	2D8	13/5	4	Heavy	200 SP
Great Hammer	2H	2D8	13/5	4	Heavy	200 SP
Greatsword	2H	2D8	13/9	4	Heavy	300 SP
Hatchet	1H/Thrown	1D6	5/9	1	Light	20 SP
Lance	Flex/Set	1D10	11/9	3	Heavy	150 SP
Longspear	2H/Set	1D8+1	9/5	2	Medium	30 SP
Longsword	Flex	1D8	13/11	2	Medium	250 SP

HANDS AND TAGS

1H: one hand. **2H:** two hands. **Flex:** two-handed use gives **+2 damage** and **STR requirement 2 lower**. **Set:** brace against a Charge (page 19). **Thrown:** use its ranged profile without an improvised-weapon penalty.

Size: determines Parry protection (page 16), not physical name or length. **ENC:** burden. **SP:** Silver Pieces. A dash means no listed value.

FLEX EXAMPLE

Two-handed longsword: **1D8 + 2 + DM**, **STR 11 / DEX 11**. Still **Medium**; using both hands prevents off-hand options. More close weapons: page 33.

CLOSE WEAPONS / M-Z

Add **DM** to listed damage. Below either STR or DEX minimum: **attacks and Parries -1P**; failing both still gives only -1P.

Weapon	Type	Damage	STR/DEX	ENC	Size	Cost
Mace	Flex	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	120 SP
Military Flail	2H	2D8	13/5	4	Heavy	200 SP
Polearm	2H/Set	1D8	9/9	3	Heavy	200 SP
Quarterstaff	2H	1D8	5/9	2	Medium	20 SP
Scimitar	1H	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	150 SP
Shield, small	1H	1D4	-	1	Medium	50 SP
Shield, medium	1H	1D6	9/-	2	Heavy	150 SP
Shield, large	1H	1D6	13/-	3	Huge	300 SP
Shortspear	Flex/Set/ Thrown	1D6	5/5	2	Medium	20 SP
Shortsword	1H	1D6	5/5	1	Medium	100 SP
Unarmed	-	1D3	-	-	Light	-
War Hammer	1H	1D8	9/9	2	Medium	120 SP

READ THE PROFILE

1H / 2H: one / two hands. **Flex:** two hands give **+2 damage** and a **STR minimum 2 lower**, without changing Size. **Set:** brace against a Charge (page 19). **Thrown:** use the ranged profile (page 35). **SP:** Silver Pieces. **ENC:** burden. Dash: no listed value.

PROTECTION AND IMPROVISATION

Small shield is **Medium**; medium shield **Heavy**; large shield **Huge**. Compare these Sizes when Parrying, not the shield's everyday name (page 16).

Primitive or improvised versions of listed weapons deal **1 less damage**, to a minimum of 1. A ranged weapon lacking Close has its own improvised use (page 21).

BOWS, CROSSBOWS & SLINGS

Ranged Combat; no DM. Below either STR/DEX minimum: **attacks and Parries -1P**; below both still only -1P.

LIGHT CROSSBOW
MOVE + BASE REACTION

HEAVY: ALL ACTIONS + ALL REACTIONS
WHOLE ROUND

Weapon	Type	Damage	Range	STR/DEX	ENC	Size	Cost
Crossbow, heavy	2H/ Missile	2D6	150 m	9/9	2	-	350 SP
Crossbow, light	2H/ Missile	1D8	125 m	5/9	1	-	150 SP
Longbow	2H/ Missile	1D10	150 m	13/9	1	-	150 SP
Shortbow	2H/ Missile	1D8	75 m	9/9	1	-	75 SP
Sling	1H/ Missile	1D6	50 m	-/9	-	-	5 SP

RANGE AND HANDS

Up to Range: normal. Beyond Range through **twice Range: -2P**. Farther: no attack. **1H / 2H:** one / two hands. **Missile:** no DM. Arrows, bolts and sling projectiles are **Light**, despite launcher Size dashes. Aim: page 21.

READY AND RELOAD

Bow: nock one arrow with Movement Action while moving up to half Movement. A generic Ready action never shortens crossbow reload costs.

SHIELDS AND AMMUNITION

A small shield may be strapped to your arm while carrying a 2H ranged weapon, but cannot attack, Parry or provide Active Guard while you wield that weapon.

Per 10: **arrows 1 SP; bolts 2 SP; sling bullets 5 CP**. Bundles have no listed ENC. **SP / CP:** Silver / Copper Pieces. **ENC:** burden. Dash: no listed value.

THROWN WEAPONS & WHIP

Use **Ranged Combat** at distance. Below either STR or DEX minimum: **attacks and Parries -1P**, only once even if both are low.

THROWN DAMAGE ADDS DM; WHIP USES ITS OWN PROFILE

Weapon	Type	Damage	Range	STR/DEX	ENC	Size	Cost
Dagger	Close/ Thrown	1D4+1	STR m	-/9	-	Light	20 SP
Dart	Thrown	1D3	STR m	-/9	-	Light	15 SP
Hatchet	Close/ Thrown	1D6	STR m	-/9	1	Light	20 SP
Improvised rock	Thrown	1D4	STR m	5/5	1	Light	-
Javelin	Thrown	1D6	STR × 2 m	5/9	1	Medium	20 SP
Shortspear	Close/ Thrown	1D6	STR × 2 m	5/9	2	Medium	20 SP
Whip	Close	1D3	5 m	-/9	-	Light	50 SP

READ THE TAGS

Thrown: ranged attacks add **DM** and retain the listed Size for Parry. **Close:** within 2 m, use Close Combat and the listed damage. Melee damage adds DM. A weapon without Close becomes an improvised **Light club, 1D6 + DM, attacking at -1P** when used within 2 m.

SP: Silver Pieces. **ENC:** burden. Dash: no listed value. Dagger melee requirements differ from this ranged profile; use the profile for the attack.

WORK OUT THE DISTANCE

Up to Range: normal. Beyond it through twice Range: **-2P**. Farther: no attack. With **STR 12**, a javelin has **24 m Range**: normal through 24 m, **-2P beyond 24 through 48 m**. Cover, Aim and defence: pages 21-22.

ARMOUR & PROTECTION

Subtract Armour Points after Parry. Armour never turns damage into healing.

LEATHER · RINGMAIL · SCALEMAIL · CHAINMAIL · PLATEMAIL

Armour	AP	ENC	Cost
Leather	2	3	500 SP
Ringmail	3	4	1,000 SP
Scalemail	4	6	1,500 SP
Chainmail	5	7	3,000 SP
Platemail	6	9	9,000 SP

RECOGNISE PROTECTION

Leather: padded, boiled leather or layered linen. **Ringmail:** sewn metal rings on padding. **Scalemail:** overlapping scales on padding. **Chainmail:** interlinked rings. **Platemail:** fitted steel plate over chain backing.

7 damage after Parry - 5 AP from Chainmail = 2 HP lost. Critical attacks have separate armour outcomes (page 17). Wearing multiple armours does not combine AP.

BURDEN AND FIT

Armour **ENC** counts toward carried load and subtracts from base **Combat Order**. Use the armour-adjusted value on your sheet; do not subtract it twice. If equipment changes, update that value. **SP:** Silver Pieces.

- **SIZ 1-5:** half listed cost and ENC.
- **SIZ 21+:** double listed cost and ENC.
- **Ill-fitting plate:** may be worn at double ENC. Other armour must fit well enough for the GM to allow it.

TRAIN WITH A WEAPON

Choose an **exact weapon type**, not one physical item. These Talents can be bought again for different weapon types, never twice for the same choice.

FAVOURED WEAPON

3 IP · passive · Close Combat 51% or Ranged Combat 51%, as used by the chosen weapon

Add **1 damage** to every damaging attack with that type, before Parry and armour. Both Close and Ranged profiles qualify, including shields and primitive versions. No benefit for improvised-club use, unarmed/natural attacks or Shaping.

No bonus when normal damage is replaced: Disarm, Trip, Shield Rush, Subdue or an undefended Critical. A Critical facing an ordinary successful Reaction still rolls normal damage, so the bonus applies.

SIGNATURE WEAPON

4 IP · passive · Favoured Weapon for the chosen weapon and Close Combat 76% or Ranged Combat 76%, as used by that weapon

For a type already covered by Favoured Weapon, increase its bonus **from +1 to +2 damage**, not +3. All Favoured Weapon restrictions remain.

WEAPON EXPERTISE

4 IP · passive · Close Combat or Ranged Combat at 76%, as used by the chosen weapon

Before an eligible normal attack, Parry, Active Guard or Opportunity Attack, declare this Talent. After ordinary cancellation, before the cap, remove **one remaining Penalty die**. It never creates a Bonus.

Use it **once per character per round across all purchases**, once on that test. The actual unmodified combat skill used must be **76%+**. Shields and primitive versions qualify; Unarmed Combat, natural weapons, Shaping and improvised use do not.

Rapid Shot and every extra off-hand attack or Reaction are ineligible.

AWARENESS & YOUR OTHER HAND

These passive Talents change positioning, acting order or the penalty on an existing option. They do not give an unrestricted second turn.

READY TO RESPOND DOES NOT MEAN EXTRA ACTIONS

BATTLE AWARENESS

3 IP · passive · Perception 51%

While aware of **at least one enemy**, attacks against you gain no +1B merely for flanking or coming from behind. Genuine surprise still applies: an attack you do not perceive may still deny a Reaction.

QUICK REFLEXES

3 IP · passive · DEX 13 and Dodge 51%

Add **2 to Combat Order** before rolling initiative. Record the adjusted value on your sheet so you add it only once.

OFF-HAND MASTERY

5 IP · passive · Close Combat 76% or Unarmed Combat 76%

Remove the core **-1P** from an extra off-hand attack, Parry or Opportunity Reaction. Every other penalty still applies.

You still choose **extra attack OR extra defence**, once per round. This grants no extra Dodge or Protector use, and a two-handed item still does not qualify. See page 18 for the underlying choice.

PROTECT WITH A SHIELD

Use a **ready shield**. Only one Reaction may answer an attack; a Talent never makes a shield available while both hands are using another weapon.

SHIELD COVER

3 IP · passive · Close Combat 51%

While aware with a ready **medium or large shield**, impose **-1P** on ranged attacks and individually targeted Projected Shapings. No Reaction cost. Use the better of Shield Cover or terrain cover, not both. No benefit against areas or Direct Harm; Dodge and Active Guard remain available.

MISSILE GUARD

2 IP · passive · Close Combat 51%

Ignore shield Active Guard's **-1P** against bows, crossbows, slings and Projected Shapings. Other penalties, including the extra off-hand -1P, remain.

PROTECTOR

2 IP · reaction · Close Combat 51%

When an adjacent ally is hit by an attack you perceive, spend your **base Reaction** to shield-Parry for them. Use normal Parry Size; apply Active Guard eligibility/modifiers for ranged attacks. Failure leaves the ally hit. The ally cannot also React to this attack, but keeps their Reaction for another trigger. Protector cannot use the extra off-hand Reaction.

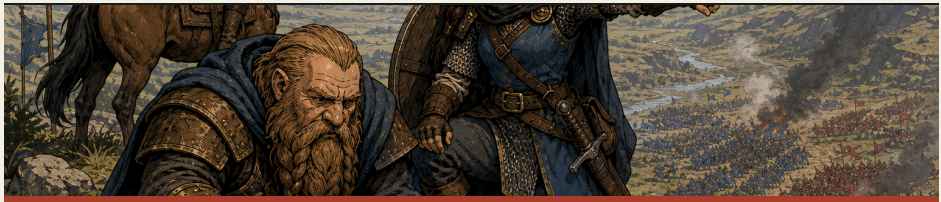
DEFENSIVE STANCE

2 IP · action · Close Combat 51%

Spend your Combat Action with a ready shield. Until your next turn begins, gain **+2 AP**, make **no attacks**, and move no more than **half Movement**. Keep defensive Reactions, including Protector. You cannot declare it after attacking or moving more than half Movement that round.

CHANGE THE FIGHT

Declare the Talent before rolling. Each uses your **Combat Action** and replaces damage when its hit is **not stopped**; see page 14.



GIVE UP DAMAGE FOR A TACTICAL RESULT

DISARM

2 IP · action · Close Combat 51%

Make a Close Combat attack. On an unstopped hit, deal **no damage**; one chosen held item lands **1D6 metres away**. It must be something the target can release, not fused, fixed or securely fastened equipment.

TRIP

3 IP · action · Close Combat 51% or Unarmed Combat 51%

Make a Close Combat or Unarmed Combat attack. On an unstopped hit, deal **no damage** and leave the target **prone**. Impossible Size or anatomy can prevent the attempt.

SHIELD RUSH

3 IP · action · Close Combat 51%

Attack with Close Combat and a ready shield. On an unstopped hit, deal **no damage** and push the target **2 metres**. It then tests **Athletics -1P** or falls prone. Impossible Size or anatomy can prevent the attempt.

BRAWL, WRESTLE & SUBDUE

Unarmed damage still adds DM. Improved strikes affect ordinary bodily attacks, not the listed damage or Size of a natural weapon.

IRON FIST

3 IP · passive · Unarmed Combat 51%

Your punches, kicks and comparable strikes deal **1D4 + DM** and count as **Medium**, replacing normal 1D3 and Light.

MASTER BRAWLER

4 IP · passive · Unarmed Combat 76% and Iron Fist

Your ordinary bodily strikes deal **1D6 + DM** and count as **Heavy**, replacing Iron Fist's values. A Medium Parry now blocks only half an ordinary hit.

WRESTLER

2 IP · action · Unarmed Combat 51%

While already grappling, spend a Combat Action and win opposed **Unarmed Combat**. Choose: deal normal unarmed damage (armour applies); drop one held item at the target's feet; or throw it to an adjacent space, **prone**, ending the grapple. Impossible Size or anatomy may prevent an outcome.

SUBDUE

3 IP · action · Close Combat 51% or Unarmed Combat 51%

Make one blunt Close or Unarmed Combat attack. If not stopped, roll listed damage + DM, then partial Parry and armour. If this reaches the target's **MWL**, it becomes stably unconscious with **no HP loss**. Otherwise it stays conscious and loses only the weapon's **minimum listed damage**, reduced by partial Parry and armour; no DM in that fallback.

Talent damage bonuses affect neither calculation. The target wakes at scene's end, immediately on damage, or after a successful Healing Combat Action.

MASTER THE RANGED SHOT

Keep range, cover and readiness rules. An exception changes only what it names.

STEADY AIM

2 IP · passive · Ranged Combat 51%

Taking a Reaction no longer loses your Aim. You still lose it on losing sight of the target, or failing to shoot with your **next Combat Action**.

POINT-BLANK SHOT

3 IP · passive · Ranged Combat 51%

Ignore the **-2P from one enemy** engaging you when making a ranged attack. Every additional enemy still gives -2P, before normal cancellation and the cap. One enemy: no engagement penalty; two: -2P. Other causes still apply.

MIGHTY SHOT

5 IP · passive · Ranged Combat 76%

Once per round, add a **positive DM** to one bow or sling attack. Zero or negative DM gives no benefit; never use it with crossbows. With Rapid Shot it applies to only one of the two attacks.

RAPID SHOT

4 IP · action · Ranged Combat 76%

Spend your Combat Action and **forfeit all Reactions** for the round to make **two bow or sling attacks at -1P each**. Resolve them one at a time; they may have different targets. The weapon must be ready for the first shot; this Talent includes loading the second missile.

No crossbows. You cannot use it after taking a Reaction that round. Weapon Expertise cannot modify Rapid Shot, and the usual Aim benefit applies only to the next eligible attack, not both shots.

STRIKE FROM AN OPENING

Being behind someone is not the same as being unseen. These Talents distinguish position, concealment and genuine lack of awareness.

SILENT STEP

3 IP · passive · Deception 51%

While moving at **half Movement or less**, Perception tests to notice you take **-1P**, whether opposed to Deception or rolled independently. It hides neither companions nor a light you carry.

KILLING ANGLE

4 IP · passive · Deception 51%

Add **1D4 damage to one Close or Unarmed attack per round** against a target you flank, strike from behind, or that is unaware of you. No ranged benefit. It adds nothing to a Critical, including one created by Ambusher.

MASTER ASSASSIN

5 IP · passive · Deception 76% and Killing Angle

Where Killing Angle applies, increase its bonus to **2D4 total**. Still only one attack per round, and nothing on a Critical.

AMBUSHER

4 IP · action · Deception 76%

Declare it before your **first attack of the scene**, from concealment against a target genuinely unaware of you. An ordinary hit becomes a **Critical**; an already Critical hit gains nothing further.

Use Close, Ranged or Unarmed Combat, not Shaping. Being distracted, outnumbered or merely surprised is not enough. This is an action Talent: no extra off-hand follow-up.

INFILTRATION & FINE WORK

Removing a Penalty happens **after ordinary cancellation, before the cap**. It never creates a Bonus die or removes a penalty outside the stated scope.

DECEPTION EXPERTISE

2 IP · passive · Deception 51%

Choose **disguise, hiding objects, picking pockets, stealth or misdirection**. Remove one remaining Penalty die from that use of Deception. Buy again only for different applications; record each choice.

CUTPURSE

2 IP · action · Deception 51%

Pick a pocket, cut a purse or plant a small object in **one Combat Action**, instead of the usual minute. Oppose **Deception against Perception**. Failure goes unnoticed unless you Fumble or the missing item is too large to overlook.

LOCKBREAKER

2 IP · action · Mechanisms 51%

Open a lock or disable a trap in **one Action**, instead of an extended attempt. A resistant device still opposes with its maker's Mechanisms. A Fumble against a trap springs it.

CLOSE-QUARTERS KNACK

2 IP · passive · DEX 13 and SIZ 9 or lower

Remove one remaining Penalty die from **Athletics or Mechanisms** when it is caused specifically by cramped surroundings. Darkness, footing, inadequate tools and enemies are not covered.

WORDS, TRADE & LEADERSHIP

Penalty removal comes after cancellation, before the cap, and creates no Bonus.

SILVER TONGUE

2 IP · passive · Influence 51%

Remove one remaining Penalty from Influence to **persuade or bargain**. You need time to talk and an audience willing to listen. Never applies to threats.

COMMANDING PRESENCE

2 IP · passive · Influence 51%

Remove one remaining Penalty from Influence to **command or threaten**, including Intimidate. The target must make you out and have something to lose. This changes your test, not modifiers on its resistance. No persuasion or bargaining benefit.

RALLY

4 IP · action · Influence 51%

Combat Action: choose **two allies** who hear and understand you. Each gets **+1B to their next single test** before their next turn ends. Unused benefits expire; a new Rally replaces an unused one. No stacking and no self-Rally.

MERCHANT'S EYE

3 IP · passive · Trade 51%

Know an ordinary item's true worth on sight. A settlement offers the selection of **one size larger**: village as town, town as city. Cities improve no further; genuinely unavailable goods do not appear.

TACTICIAN

4 IP · passive · Lore (Military Tactics) 51%

An army you command takes **half normal battle casualties**. When your beaten force passes its rout test, it may keep fighting rather than withdraw; other commanders need a Critical. The GM handles the battle procedure.

SKILLED HANDS & CARE

Use normal treatment and tool rules unless the Talent explicitly changes them.

PRACTISED HANDS

4 IP · passive · Healing 51%

After-encounter treatment restores **1D4 + 2 HP**. If it fails, you may try once more on that patient before their next full rest. Never more than one success per patient; this does not replace Surgery for a Major Wound.

FIELD SURGEON

3 IP · passive · Healing 76%

Attempt Surgery wherever you can stop and work, without a prepared place. Still **outside combat**, with a Healing Kit, restoring **1 HP**. Your successful Surgery ends **Wounded immediately**, without waiting for HP to exceed MWL.

PHYSICIAN

3 IP · passive · Healing 76%

Your successful Healing gives **+2B instead of +1B** against poison or disease. A patient you treated may also make **one extra resistance test** against a poison that beat them; ordinary poison gives no retry.

MASTER CRAFTSMAN

4 IP · passive · Craft 76%

Materials cost **one quarter of finished value**, not half. Crafted items have **ENC 1 lower, minimum 1**. Armour you make raises its wearer's Combat Order by 1.

WEAK POINT

3 IP · passive · Engineering 51%

With access and quiet, examine a structure for **10 minutes**, then test Engineering. Success identifies an accessible load-bearing join: attacks there **ignore object AP** until repaired or materially changed. Failure gives no benefit; retry only after a material change.

TRAVEL & TERRAIN TALENTS

Remove Penalties **after ordinary cancellation and before the cap**. Removal never creates a Bonus. Record any specialism alongside the Talent's name.

ATHLETICS EXPERTISE

2 IP · passive · Athletics 51%

Choose **acrobatics, brute force, climbing, jumping, running or swimming**. Remove one remaining Penalty from Athletics using that application. Buy again only for different applications, never twice for the same one.

TERRAIN EXPERTISE

2 IP · passive · Natural Lore 51%

Choose a terrain, such as **forest, mountain, desert, swamp, steppe or coast**. Remove one remaining Penalty from Natural Lore in or about that terrain. You may buy it again for different terrains. It may combine with Tracker.

TRACKER

2 IP · passive · Natural Lore 51%

Remove one remaining Penalty from Natural Lore to **find or follow a trail**. No benefit to other Natural Lore uses. With applicable Terrain Expertise, the two Talents may remove two remaining Penalties, never produce a Bonus.

WAYFINDER

2 IP · passive · Natural Lore 51%

While you can see the sky or read the ground, downgrade a navigation **Fumble to Failure**. That test does not make the group lost. It does not prevent other hazards or remove weather, pace, food, water or shelter requirements.

ALCHEMY & POISON

Each Talent makes **one dose per day**, spending **50 SP of materials**. A dose keeps its potency for **one month**. Decide its effect when brewing it.

ALCHEMIST

4 IP · passive · Lore (Alchemy) 51%

Choose one:

- **Antidote:** +2B to one resistance test against a named poison or disease.
- **Salve:** restore **1D6 HP** over an hour's rest, once per patient per day.
- **Alchemical fire:** ready Light flask; Ranged Combat, **Range 10 m**, **1D6 fire damage**, no DM. Normal Reactions apply. A miss wastes it; a Fumble can use the usual crowd-hit consequence.

POISONER

4 IP · passive · Lore (Alchemy) 76% and Alchemist

The poison's **Potency is half your Lore (Alchemy)**. Choose one Effect: **1D6 HP damage**, **-2 to one characteristic**, or **unconsciousness**. An ongoing Effect lasts **1D6 × 10 minutes**.

Choose **smeared**, Delay **1 round**, or **ingested**, Delay **1D6 minutes**. Applying a smeared dose to a suitable cutting/piercing weapon costs a Combat Action. It is spent on the **first hit that deals HP damage**, or after one hour. Ingested poison activates when consumed.

The victim gets the normal **single Resilience-versus-Potency test** after the Delay. Re-exposure to the same currently active poison neither stacks nor grants another resistance. Treatment and exceptions: page 31.

BECOME A SHAPER

Shaping builds magic from **what you affect** and **what you do to it**, rather than giving every caster the same fixed spell list.

LEARN EXACT CELLS; BUILD EFFECTS FROM THEM

SHAPING

20 IP · passive · A supernatural initiation or discovery

Gain the **Shaping Knowledge skill**, base **INT + POW**, one specialty (a Form or Technique), and **two known cells containing that specialty**. You also gain Sense Magic and Dispel. Without this Talent, you cannot cast.

Example: choose Fire as your specialty, then learn **Unmake·Fire** and **Ward·Fire**. This grants neither Conjure·Fire nor any other Unmake cell.

BEGINNING PLAY WITH MAGIC

Reserve and pay **20 IP before allocating skills**; you may then put up to 30 Knowledge points into Shaping. The full-price trade example is on page 11. With INT 14 and POW 13, base 27% plus 30 points gives **Shaping 57%**.

DEFINE PRACTICE AND TELL

Practice: observable and interruptible speech, gesture, focus, prayer or similar requirement. If prevented, you cannot cast. **Tell:** the unavoidable magical sign around you and any ranged target/area. Watchers notice it; it is also noticeable within **10 × M metres, minimum 3 m**. It reveals magic, not its purpose. Only Veiled can conceal it.

LEARN MORE LATER

New cell containing your specialty: **2 IP**. Other cell: **4 IP**, needing a significant ordeal or master. Suitable experience is required. Shaping skill improves normally; new cells do not raise it.

FORMS & TECHNIQUES

Technique + Form = cell. Learn each of the sixty possible cells separately. The method must fit both halves.

THE FORM: WHAT YOU AFFECT

Form	Governs
Fire	Flame, heat and light.
Water/Ice	Water, cold and ice.
Air/Storm	Air, wind, sound, weather and lightning.
Earth/Stone	Soil, stone and natural minerals; not all worked metal.
Flesh	Biology: living/dead bodies, plants, corporeal undead.
Mind	Thought, emotion, memory and perception; not Mindless subjects.
Force/Motion	Kinetic force, movement, weight and mass.
Spirit	Souls, Spirits and possession; not Soulless targets.
Paths	Routes, thresholds and distance; not time travel.
Fate	Unresolved chance, omens, vows and contingencies.

THE TECHNIQUE: WHAT YOU DO

Technique	Permission
Conjure	Create matter, phenomena, routes or beings; no arrival strike.
Bend	Move, direct or control what exists; no direct damage.
Unmake	Harm, destroy, suppress, sever or banish.
Alter	Heal, transform or impose conditions; no direct damage.
Ward	Protect, resist or deny; no absolute immunity below I5.
Scry	Information, communication or senses; do not change the subject.

Only Dispel ends an active Shaping. Intelligent undead have minds, but all undead are Soulless. Flesh can affect corporeal undead; Spirit cannot.

BUILD AN EFFECT

Say: **using [known cell], I cause [outcome], at [Range], affecting [Reach], for [Duration]**. The GM confirms the build and defence before you roll.

MAGNITUDE = SUM OF OUTCOME INTENSITIES + RANGE + DURATION + REACH + ADJUSTMENTS

INTENSITY	MAGNITUDE
EFFECT STRENGTH	COST & LOAD

CHOOSE THE OUTCOME FIRST

Intensity (I) buys strength: choose a benchmark on page 53-55. **I2 healing restores 2D4 HP per target.** Then set Range, Duration and Reach.

Pay each distinct outcome's I and shared dials once. **Confluence** permits two cells. Never stack an outcome on one subject to evade I limits.

YOUR SKILL LIMITS BOTH STRENGTH AND SAFETY

Shaping	Expertise	Maximum I / Safe M
0-25%	Novice	1 / 1
26-50%	Apprentice	2 / 2
51-75%	Veteran	3 / 3
76-99%	Expert	4 / 4
100%	Master	5 / 5

Every outcome stays within maximum I. Ordinary casting reaches **Safe M + 2** with overreach risk. More PP, Talents and rituals never raise maximum I. I5 itself always requires a ritual.

RANGE: HOW FAR

0: self/touch. **1:** within 15 m. **2:** within 50 m. **3:** any visible point. **4:** familiar, marked or mystically linked target in the same realm, ritual. **5:** another realm/plane, Mythic ritual.

Range 1-3 needs an **unobstructed route**. Seeing through a barrier is not enough; Indirect can cross it when the Form permits.

DURATION, REACH & EXAMPLES

Add each chosen rating **once** to Magnitude. **R** marks a ritual-only rating; any rating of 5 also requires a declared lasting mythic price.

DURATION: HOW LONG

Rating	Duration
0	Instant, or through the affected subject's next turn.
1	One scene or 10 minutes.
2	Until the target next fully rests, maximum 8 hours.
3 R	One week.
4 R	Indefinite until dismissed or Dispelled.
5 R	Permanent.

Duration sustains state; **never repeats damage, healing or a lost Action**.

REACH: USE THE HIGHEST REQUIREMENT

Rating	Count / radius; largest subject
0	One; person, door or human-sized object.
1	2 / 3 m; wagon or large tree.
2	5 / 10 m; room-sized structure.
3 R	20 / 50 m; building or ship.
4 R	100 / 500 m; settlement.
5 R	Army, city or region; landscape.

Areas include allies unless Selective. Direct Harm uses **selected targets, not a radius**.

TWO READY BUILDS

Firebolt at 15 m: Unmake·Fire, I2 + R1 + D0 + Reach0 = **M3**. Deal **2D6 Projected Harm** once; normal armour applies.

Ward two allies at 15 m for a scene: Ward·Earth/Stone, I2 + R1 + D1 + Reach1 = **M5**. Grant **4 AP against physical blows**. At Shaping 60%, the first is safe; the second is **Safe + 2: -2P**. Ordinary success costs 3 PP or 5 PP respectively.

HARM, HEAL & PROTECT

Use the lowest I that buys the result. Your cell must explain the method; its description never gives free damage, protection or extra actions.

COMMON OUTCOMES

Outcome	What the Intensity buys
Harm	Unmake: **I D6**. No DM. Choose Projected or Direct delivery before M.
Heal	Alter·Flesh: **I D4 HP**, up to maximum.
Ward	**2 × I AP** against one defined class of harm. Use it or physical armour, whichever protects better; never add them.
Barrier	**2 × I AP; 5 × I total HP**. Reach sets footprint.
Vitality reserve	**3 × I** points absorb qualifying HP damage after other protection, before HP/MWL.
Skill / defence modifier	**I2: +1B / -1P. I4: +2B / -2P.** Name one skill or narrow family.

WHAT HEALING FIXES

Healing also removes **Bleeding and Dying**. Above 0 HP, act next turn. **I3+** counts as Surgery; Wounded ends after treatment when HP exceeds MWL. Healing never repeats through Duration and creates no regeneration pool.

Poison/disease curing needs **I × 25 at least Potency**, then Shaping must win against Potency. After failure, the same Shaper needs full rest, new treatment, discovery or another meaningful change before retrying.

PROTECTION HAS LIMITS

Keep only the strongest same-kind magical modifier/protection. A reserve cannot refill; keep only the larger of a new reserve or existing remaining points. It changes neither maximum HP nor MWL and absorbs no PP damage or paid sacrifice.

A solid barrier blocks movement and route, never appears through occupied space. Trapping an unwilling subject is hostile restraint: it chooses Dodge or Resilience.

MOVE, SENSE & LEARN

The cell chooses the method. Wings, a force lift and a stone stair can solve the same problem without using the same targets, defences or consequences.

GRANT A CAPABILITY

Capability	Benchmark
New movement mode	**I2:** climb/swim or traverse a named surface at normal Movement. **I3:** fly at normal Movement.
Pass through matter	**I4:** one named mundane substance, half Movement; finish each Movement Action in empty space or return to entry.
Increase one mode's speed	**I1: +3 m; I2: ×1.5; I3: ×2; I4: ×3.** Separate from buying the mode.
Sense	**I1:** Low-Light Sight. **I2:** Night Vision or narrow environmental sense. **I3:** Blind Sight with named blocker. **I4:** broad sense of one defined class.
Breathing	**I1:** hold breath 10 minutes. **I2:** breathe one named medium. **I3:** no need to breathe.

Use your own **Movement Action** for a granted mode; the Shaper need not spend an Action maintaining a passive benefit. Dangerous movement can still need Athletics. If flight ends unsupported, you fall. Breathing water gives neither swimming nor protection from pressure, heat or contact hazards.

SCRY: INFORMATION, NOT CERTAINTY

I1: immediate clue/presence. **I2:** locate, diagnose, communicate or see through ordinary concealment. **I3:** distant observation, surface thoughts, deeply hidden evidence. **I4:** guarded memory, history, motives or possible futures.

Live observation, communication and thought-reading require **concentration**; static facts and fixed senses do not. Scry cannot reveal evidence absent from accessible minds, places or traces. Senses use Perception when noticing is uncertain. Use only the best relevant sense; blockers and the Form's scope remain.

CONDITIONS & ESCAPING THEM

Price exact consequences. **"Paralysed" gives no free damage, helplessness, movement or control.**

COMMON HOSTILE OUTCOMES

I	What it can do
1	Prone, or a brief hindrance such as half Movement through next turn.
2	Restrain; -1P to one skill/family or one sense.
3	Suppress one sense; remove **one Combat Action once**; serious tactical compulsion.
4	No Actions/Reactions while incapacitated; or full bodily/mental control with active maintenance.

A lost Combat Action never repeats; the target is immune until it completes a later Combat Action.

RETRY AT THE RIGHT TIME

Usually spend a **Combat Action** to retry the original defence against **stored Shaping**; win to escape. If Combat Actions are prevented, retry freely **at your own turn's end**, after its restrictions. Winning **does not restore missed Actions**; it does not require being conscious.

Example: bind, stored success 42. Resilience 60% rolls 55: success and higher, so you escape. The Shaper does not reroll. Magical sleep may instead end on damage or an adjacent ally's waking Combat Action.

CONTROL AND RESTORATION

I1 can colour emotion; I2 compels a limited reasonable act, not a combat Action, tactical disadvantage or action against interests. Such compulsion needs I3. Compelled acts use the subject's own turn and Action. Full control needs the Shaper's Combat Action; serious self-harm, defining betrayal or violated central belief gives another Persistence defence. Certain death always does.

Dispel active magic. For nonmagical Fatigue, I3 removes Fatigued or reduces Exhausted to Fatigued; I4 removes Exhausted. An ongoing cause remains.

CAST & PAY THE COST

One Combat Action. Keep your Movement and eligible Reactions. You need Practice, Tell, a valid target/route, room in your active limit and PP for **full M**.

RESOLVE IN ORDER

Agree cell, outcomes, M and defence. Roll Shaping. Resolve **Counter, then defence**; pay PP, then apply the effect. A defence stopping it does not refund the casting cost. A Critical keeps its grade, never maximises magical effect dice.

RISK AND PAYMENT

Up to Safe M: no Magnitude penalty. **Safe + 1: -1P. Safe + 2: -2P**. Higher M requires a ritual. Removing/cancelling penalties never removes overreach.

Result	PP and consequence
Critical	Pay **half M**, rounded up; resolve defence normally.
Success	Pay **full M**.
Failure within Safe	No effect; lose **1 PP**.
Failed overreach	No effect; lose **half M** and suffer Backlash.
Fumble	No intended effect; lose **full M** and suffer Backlash.

Hero Point rerolls happen **before PP loss or Backlash**. At 0 PP, the casting resolves first, then living Shapers fall unconscious and concentration ends. PP recovery is on page 8.

HOSTILE TOUCH

First make a **no-damage Unarmed Combat delivery attack** in that Action; normal Reactions apply. No Talent or off-hand attack. If stopped, spend the Action but no PP and make no Shaping roll. Contact then needs casting and normal resistance. A delivery Critical adds nothing; partial Parry does not stop contact.

BACKLASH AND TRICKS

The GM resolves Backlash: harm, extra PP loss, a stray effect or Fatigue. **I0 is cosmetic only**. A calm M0 Trick is free and automatic; under pressure, failure does nothing and Fumble gives an inconvenient Tell, not PP loss or Backlash.

DEFEND AGAINST MAGIC

Shaping is opposed, unlike weapon attacks. The caster must succeed and win; a winning shield guard instead uses Size.

MATCH THE INCOMING METHOD

Effect	Defence
Individual projection	**Dodge -1P or ready shield guard -1P**, spending an eligible Reaction.
Avoidable area	**Dodge -1P**; no shield guard.
Bodily/material change or restraint	**Resilience**, no Reaction cost.
Mind/soul effect	**Persistence**, no Reaction cost.
Self / willing / unattended	No defence.

Dodge uses the base Reaction, once per round. Each subject defends separately; same-defence outcomes against one subject share a roll. Ongoing areas store the initial result: leaving suspends the effect; re-entry gives no new defence.

HARM DELIVERY: CHOOSE BEFORE M

Projected: no extra M; crosses space, normal armour applies. Terrain cover gives caster -1P partial, -2P substantial; complete barriers block the route. **Direct: +1 M**, selected targets only, never radius. Resilience resists bodily harm; Persistence resists Spirit harm. Ignore nonmagical AP, not Wards or named resistances. No Dodge/guard; Direct still needs a valid route.

Spirit Harm: Direct only, **I D6 PP**, not HP; Soulless targets are invalid. Mind never deals HP damage. Critical Shaping uses normal effect dice and protection.

SHIELDS: EACH OUTCOME HAS AN IMPACT SIZE

I1 Light · I2 Medium · I3 Heavy · I4 Huge · I5 Beyond Huge.
Winning guard: same/larger blocks the outcome; one smaller halves its damage; two smaller blocks none. A winning Critical guard blocks all. A separate non-damage outcome needs its own successful Size block. No weapons against magic. Shield Cover/Missile Guard work as stated; Counter is on page 59.

KEEP MAGIC ACTIVE

Total ongoing **Magnitude cannot exceed permanent, unmodified INT**. Record each effect's **M, Duration and casting result**. Dismiss on your turn without an Action.

INT 10: KEEP AT MOST 10 MAGNITUDE ACTIVE

M4 WARD + M4 FLIGHT
8: FITS

ADD ANOTHER ONGOING M3
11: TOO MUCH

Dismiss one first. An instant M3 firebolt leaves no ongoing M.

PASSIVE OR ACTIVELY DIRECTED?

Passive benefit: needs Duration, no maintenance Action. Examples: armour, subject-directed flight, fixed senses. A Critical still counts **full M**. An instant effect adds no ongoing M once resolved.

Concentration / active control: your Combat Action each round, only one; keep the subject within Range and a valid route. Damage or serious distraction forces Persistence or maintenance ends. Summon commands instead use 15 m and line of effect. Fixed-duration passive magic normally checks route only when set.

SENSE MAGIC: NO CELL NEEDED

Combat Action + **1 PP**; Shaping test for active magic within **15 m**. Success gives location/Form; Critical adds Technique, M and state. Failure: nothing; Fumble: false impression and obvious Tell, not Backlash. Veiled magic opposes with its original result. Practice and Tell still apply.

DISPEL: NO CELL NEEDED

Combat Action; **M = target's full M + Range**, Reach 0 for one Shaping even if it covers an area. Cast/pay normally. You must succeed and win against the original caster's **current unmodified Shaping**, not its stored casting roll. If unknown, use 10 × original M, capped 100%.

Active anchored enchantments can be Dispelled. Completed permanent transformations cannot: reversing them needs a new appropriate Shaping.

COUNTER & CASTING TRAINING

These are purchased exceptions. Merely reaching an expertise tier does not grant its similarly named Talent.

COUNTER

4 IP · reaction · Shaping 51%

Perceive a successful Shaping cast within **15 m**, or its projection entering within 15 m. Before defence/effect, spend your **base Reaction**; you need current PP at least its full M. Oppose Shaping against the **original result**; you must succeed and win to stop it.

Pay **full M either way**; a Fumble also causes Backlash at that M. Only one Counter may answer a Shaping, and Counter cannot be Countered.

Counter replaces your own defence. If it fails to stop the Shaping, you cannot then Dodge, guard, or roll Resilience/Persistence against it. Another character's failed Counter leaves your own defence available.

STEADY CASTING

3 IP · passive · Shaping 76%

Before ordinary cancellation, ignore **one total Penalty die** caused by Wounded or grappling on Shaping tests. Both conditions together still remove only one. Other penalties remain; prevented Practice still prevents casting.

SHAPING EXPERTISE

5 IP · passive · Shaping 76%

Once per round, declare before a Shaping casting roll. After ordinary cancellation, before the cap, remove one remaining Penalty; never gain a Bonus. This does not change M, Safe M, maximum I, ritual requirements or Backlash risk. No benefit to Sense Magic, Dispel or Counter; purchase only once.

If both training Talents apply, use Steady Casting first, then ordinary cancellation, then Shaping Expertise.

LEARN SHAPING ADJUSTMENTS

Buy the Talent once; its **added Magnitude is paid in each build that uses it**. Additional distinct outcomes within one known cell need no adjustment Talent.

SELECTIVE

3 IP · passive · Shaping 51%

+1 M: name subjects within an area whom the effect excludes. Without it, an area affects everyone in it, including allies.

INDIRECT

3 IP · passive · Shaping 51%

+1 M per barrier crossed, where the Form permits. Supplies the route for Range 1-3, concentration/control, or casting past complete cover.

VEILED

3 IP · passive · Shaping 51%

+1 M and -1P to Shaping: conceal the Tell. Noticing it requires Perception opposed by Shaping. Practice stays interruptible; someone detecting the Tell in time can Counter. Without this Talent, a Tell cannot be concealed.

CONFLUENCE

5 IP · passive · Shaping 76%

+1 M: combine **exactly two known cells**, each contributing a distinct permitted outcome. Pay every outcome's I; count shared dials once. One Combat Action, roll, PP payment and Tell.

Each outcome keeps its own delivery, targets, defence and protection. Same-defence outcomes against one subject share a defence roll; different defences/subjects do not. Counter stops the whole Shaping; Dispel ends the whole ongoing Shaping. One outcome may depend on another succeeding, but never earns a discount/refund.

MAKE MAGIC WAIT

A Trigger stores **one already-built effect** until a declared observable event. It is not a way to add damage to every hit or choose a target later.

TRIGGER

4 IP · passive · Shaping 76%

Add **+1 M plus a second Duration rating for the wait**. The effect still has its own Duration. State the event when building it; hidden qualities require Scry.

An ordinary casting arms it immediately: fix **target, cell, outcomes, Range, Reach and all other dials**, then check target/route. These choices cannot change when it fires. Counter happens at casting; normal target defence happens when it fires, against the **stored Shaping result**.

For an Activated/Charged item, activation arms one use and fixes its target and permitted choices. Pay PP or spend the charge then, even if the wait expires. The item's observable event was fixed when made.

ONE HIT CAN BE THE EVENT

A successful weapon hit on the **already chosen target** may trigger magic. Resolve the weapon, then the separate Shaping with its normal defence/protection. It inherits no DM or weapon-Critical benefits. A miss leaves the Trigger waiting.

Damage cannot retaliate for an attack against or harm suffered by the caster, bearer or another protected subject. It cannot repeat on later weapon hits.

EXAMPLE: ONE PREPARED FOLLOW-UP

"When I next hit **that ogre** this scene, sear it for 2D6." Unmake·Fire, **I2 + R1 + Direct1 + Trigger1 + wait D1 = M6**; effect D0, Reach0. The hit fires it once; the ogre still opposes the Direct Harm with **Resilience**. If the scene ends without the hit, the paid Trigger expires.

ILLUSIONS, PATHS & FATE

These methods can look similar to other magic, but have different targets and limits.

HIDE A SUBJECT OR CHANGE A MIND

I2: -1P to detect through one sense. **I3:** imperceptible through one sense. **I4:** every sense the cell governs. Impairing a perceiver uses the same grades. I3+ sight loss uses Pitch black attack/vision limits; general blindness also quarters Movement, while invisibility does not darken the surroundings.

Conjure·Mind: perceive something absent. **Alter·Mind:** change/omit what is present. Reach counts **each affected mind**; each resists Persistence. Later observers, devices and Mindless beings perceive normally. Illusions never harm. A fooled witness may spend an Action to oppose Perception with stored Shaping; winning identifies falsehood, not hidden matter. Failure needs new evidence. Fixed illusions need no maintenance; directing behaviour costs the caster's Action.

PATHS: SAFE DESTINATIONS ONLY

Bend·Paths I2: move a willing subject, or unwilling one up to 3 m. **I3:** unwilling relocation within Range; **I4** if relocation alone removes it from the encounter. Unwilling subjects resist Resilience.

Conjure·Paths I3+: stationary one-way portal. Crossing costs a Movement Action and spends its Reach allowance. Range reaches both ends; arrival must be empty, stable, large enough and safe from unavoidable harm/confinement. No free collision, falling, restraint or damage. Invalid arrival moves nobody.

FATE: BEFORE UNCERTAINTY RESOLVES

I1: non-numerical omen/coincidence. **I2: +1B/-1P; I4: +2B/-2P** on a named test or narrow endeavour. Later events require Trigger; hostile Fate faces Persistence. Vows do not compel choice. No HP damage, rerolls, automatic success, chosen dice, extra actions or retroactive changes. Predictions are possibilities.

SUMMON & DIRECT A BEING

Only **one combat-capable summon or actively controlled subject**, regardless of Reach.

A GENERIC COMBAT SUMMON

I	HP	AP	Attack / defence	Damage
1	3	0	25%	1D3
2	6	1	40%	1D6
3	10	2	55%	1D8
4	14	3	70%	2D6

Movement 15, one Movement Action and one base Reaction. It acts immediately after you. Defence covers Dodge, Resilience, Persistence and possible physical Parry. No DM; it ignores Major Wounds and vanishes at 0 HP.

It may move, communicate and defend without commands. A consequential act costs **your Combat Action and its corresponding Action**. Commands need **15 m and line of effect**. It gains no extra Action from the command.

PAY FOR SPECIAL CAPABILITIES

Flight, incorporeality, invisibility, spellcasting, extra armour or special senses are not included just because the description suggests them. They raise minimum Intensity or require additional outcomes. Range sets generic arrival; Duration and the active limit still apply.

CALLING A NAMED BEING

Its profile sets the necessary Intensity; calling must also reach its location or realm. An unwilling being resists with Persistence. **Calling is not control**: binding/command is another resisted outcome. It remembers treatment and may demand terms. After the magic ends, any willing stay gives no guaranteed service.

Created, summoned, transformed or compelled beings cannot summon, contribute PP, create magical resources or pay ritual prices. Conjure·Flesh can animate remains as temporary Mindless, Soulless undead; it restores no former identity or loyalty.

RITUALS & LASTING MAGIC

Required for **M above Safe + 2; I5; Range 4+; Reach 3+; or Duration 3+**. Rituals do not raise maximum I or make powerful effects free.

PREPARE, THEN TEST

Spend **one hour per M** in a prepared place, with full Practice and a fitting focus/offering. Maximum M is the greater of **Safe + 2 or twice Safe**. Exceeding it needs an exceptional campaign event and a serious lasting price.

M compared with Safe	Base penalty
Up to Safe	None.
1-2 above	-1P.
3+ above	-2P.

Then apply the ritual's **+1B**, assistance and circumstances, cancel and cap. Failure above Safe is still overreach. Use normal PP payment results.

SHARE THE PP, NOT THE ROLL

Willing participants stay and join Practice. Pledge full M in a declared order; the leader pledges at least 1 PP and pays the first point. Critical leaves unused pledges unspent. One capable Shaper may Assist; only the leader rolls and suffers Backlash. A Fumble also advances every contributor one Fatigue step; already Exhausted means unconscious 3D6 minutes, waking Fatigued.

INDEFINITE OR PERMANENT

Indefinite: leader personally commits full M from current and maximum PP, even on Critical; no contributors. Leave at least 1 available maximum PP unless declared mythic helplessness. Ending restores maximum, not spent current PP.

Any dial at 5 is Mythic: agree a lasting price. Materials are consumed at the start; lasting changes attach after success, or on Fumble only if declared. Permanent mundane creation needs equivalent material. Completed transformations become inactive; supernatural properties remain anchored, Dispellable magic. A price never discounts M, PP, active load or enchantment capacity.

USE A MAGICAL ITEM

No Shaping skill or cell needed. Items show their maker's Tell; hostile effects face the maker's **stored Shaping result**.

ANYONE CAN USE AN ENCHANTMENT; ITS COST STILL MATTERS

THREE WAYS TO POWER IT

Kind	What you pay
Continuous	Active while worn/held; commits your maximum PP equal to M. Removing it restores that maximum.
Activated	Combat Action and **M PP** for each reusable activation. You need enough available PP.
Charged	Combat Action and **one stored charge**; the maker prepaid it. No PP cost to you.

Potions and scrolls are one-charge items, spent on use. A multi-charge item becomes ordinary or is destroyed after its last charge, as its maker declared. Continuous items cannot give a depletable vitality reserve; each new reserve needs an Activated use or stored charge.

A TRIGGER ARMS ONE USE

Activation fixes its target and allowed choices, paying PP or charge even if the event never occurs. It fires once without another Action. Continuous items cannot use Trigger. No item retaliates with damage or adds Shaping damage to repeated weapon hits; each new effect needs a new paid use.

IDENTIFY OR END IT

Sense Magic reveals magic/Form; Critical adds Technique, M and anchored state. **Scry the matching Form:** I2 diagnoses use and effect; I3 reveals a concealed curse, limitation or Trigger. Do not assume what an unidentified item does.

Destroy its vulnerable anchor or Dispel through it to end the enchantment. Completed permanent transformations are different: they cannot be Dispelled.

MAKE AN ENCHANTMENT

Build a Shaping and bind it to a **vulnerable physical or spiritual anchor** during a ritual. Duration **4** is ordinary enduring work; **5** is Mythic and also needs its lasting price. Your expertise still limits ritual M and outcome I.

ENCHANTER

10 IP · passive · Shaping 51%

Gain **Enchantment Capacity equal to permanent, unmodified POW**. A bound effect moves its full M into this capacity instead of occupying your PP commitment or active M. It persists without you. Pay the PP for each Charged use when binding it.

Continuous/Activated: count full final M once per effect. **Charged:** count full M **for every unused charge**. Each separately bound layer counts. Every effect stays attributed to its original creator, even after sale, gift or theft. Helpers never inherit its capacity cost. Mythic effects have no exemption.

Creation, restoration and increases must fit capacity. Only a **permanently ended effect** frees capacity: Dispel, destroyed anchor or spent charge. Reusable activation and temporary suppression free none.

If permanent POW loss leaves you over capacity, items persist. You cannot create, restore or increase enchantments until the total fits again.

EXAMPLE: COUNT USES, NOT OBJECTS

POW 12: one Activated M4 effect uses 4 capacity. Two stored M3 charges use another 6, for **10 total**. A third M3 charge would make 13 and cannot fit. Using one M3 charge frees 3 capacity; using the Activated item frees none.

WITHOUT ENCHANTER

Duration 4 **and** Duration 5 enchantments instead commit the maker's full M from maximum PP and count against active M. The Mythic price is additional, not a replacement for either commitment. Item users still pay their own listed costs.

Temporary conjured matter vanishes with Duration; it cannot supply permanent crafting material, value or ritual prices.

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